

EXPERIMENT 1

Form Creation in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To develop a basic student information form using the Zoho Creator platform for collecting and managing student data, and to understand the process of designing a form with suitable fields and input components.

2. Introduction

Zoho Creator is a low-code application development platform that helps users build customized applications with minimal programming. It provides a visual form builder where fields can be added, configured, and arranged to collect structured information. The submitted data can then be stored and managed within the application.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To understand the basic steps involved in creating a form using Zoho Creator.
- To learn how different fields can be added and configured in a form.
- To understand how forms collect and store structured student information.
- To configure mandatory fields and simple validation settings.
- To create, preview, and verify a functional student information form.

4. Procedure

1. Log in to the Zoho Creator platform.
2. Create a new application or open the required application.
3. Create a new form using the Form Builder.
4. Add fields such as Student Name, Register Number, Department, Email, Phone Number, Date of Birth, and Gender.
5. Select suitable field types such as Name, Number, Dropdown, Email, Phone, Date, and Radio.
6. Mark required fields as mandatory and adjust their properties.
7. Organize the fields in a clear and logical sequence.
8. Save and preview the form to check the layout and input fields.
9. Enter sample student details and verify that the information can be submitted and stored.

5. Illustrative Example

A Student Management System can use a Student Profile form to capture essential student details. The form is designed to keep data entry simple while storing the information in an organized structure.

5.1 Implementation using Zoho Creator

- **Student Name** – Name field for entering the student's first and last name.
- **Register Number** – Number field for entering the student's register number.
- **Department** – Dropdown field for choosing the student's department.
- **Email** – Email field for recording the student's email address.
- **Phone Number** – Phone field for storing contact information.
- **Date of Birth** – Date field for recording the student's date of birth.
- **Gender** – Radio field for selecting the appropriate option.

5.2 Form Design

The screenshot displays the Zoho Creator Form Builder interface for a 'Student Management System' under the 'Academic Records' app. The main workspace shows a form with the following fields:

- Student Name**: A text field with a person icon, marked as mandatory.
- Email**: An email field, marked as mandatory.
- Program Name**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.
- Enrollment Date**: A date field, marked as mandatory.
- Academic Level**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.
- GPA**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.
- Semester**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.
- course code**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.
- year**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.
- Status**: A text field with a dropdown arrow, marked as mandatory.

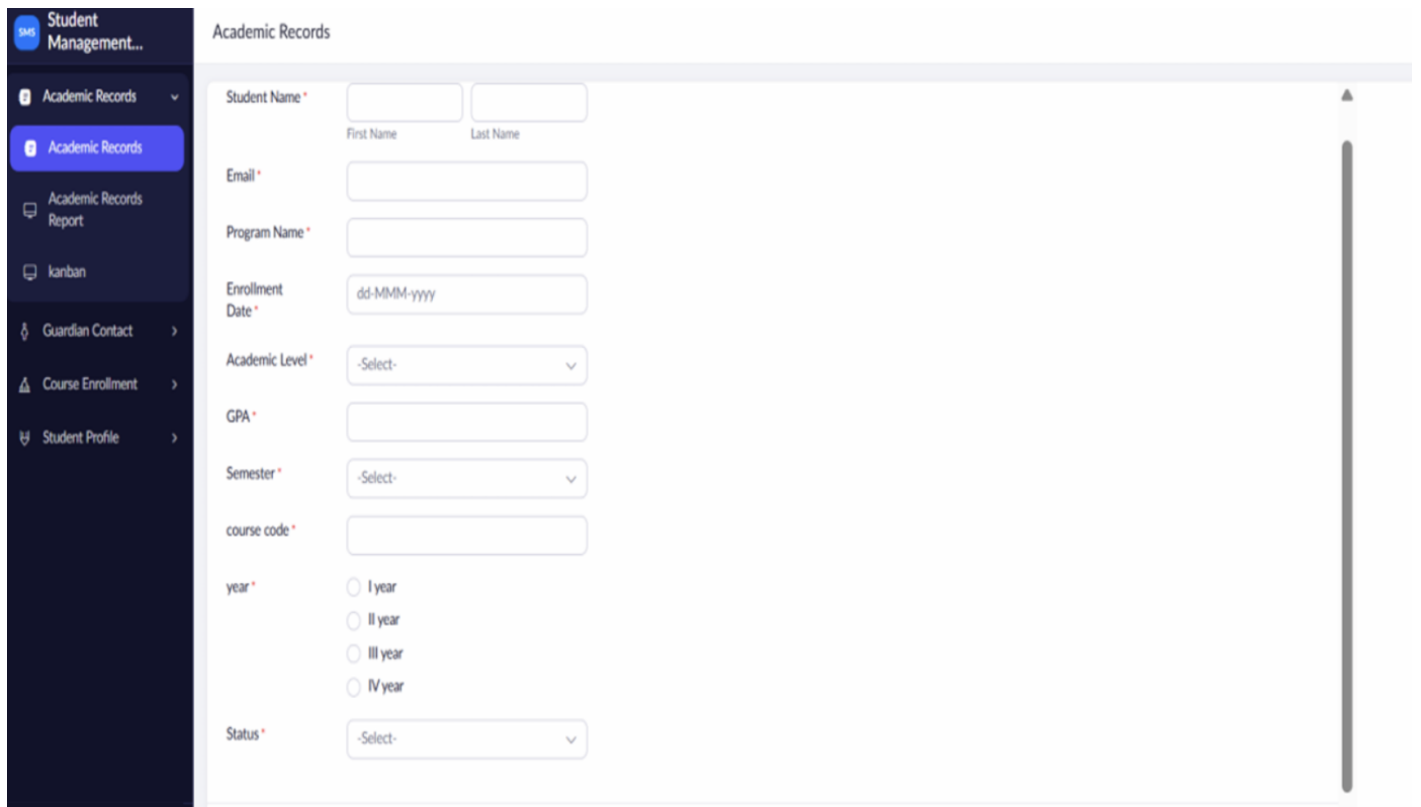
On the left, the 'Basic Fields' palette includes icons for Name, Email, Address, Phone, Single Line, Multi Line, Number, Date, Time, and Drop Down. On the right, the 'Field Properties' panel for the 'Student Name' field shows:

- Field name**: Student Name
- Field link name**: Student_Name
- View Field References**: A link to view references.
- Validation**: ☒ Mandatory
- Display Fields**: ☐ Prefix, ☒ First Name, ☒ Last Name, ☐ Suffix
- Data Privacy**: A section for data privacy settings.

The bottom of the interface includes a status bar with 'Trial expires in 8 days', an 'Upgrade' button, and a 'Help' button.

Figure 1: Zoho Creator Form Builder showing the configured fields.

5.3 Form Preview



The image shows a Zoho Creator form titled "Student Management...". The form is divided into two main sections: "Academic Records" and "Student Profile". The "Academic Records" section contains the following fields:

- Student Name ***: Two text input fields labeled "First Name" and "Last Name".
- Email ***: A text input field.
- Program Name ***: A text input field.
- Enrollment Date ***: A date input field with a placeholder "dd-MMM-yyyy".
- Academic Level ***: A dropdown menu with "-Select-" as the selected option.
- GPA ***: A text input field.
- Semester ***: A dropdown menu with "-Select-" as the selected option.
- course code ***: A text input field.
- year ***: A radio button group with four options: "I year", "II year", "III year", and "IV year".
- Status ***: A dropdown menu with "-Select-" as the selected option.

The "Student Profile" section is partially visible on the right side of the form.

Figure 2: Zoho Creator preview of the Student Management form.

6. Advantages and Limitations

Advantages

- Simple and visual form-building process.
- Reduces development time for basic applications.
- Different field types can be configured without extensive coding.
- Mandatory fields and basic validation can be applied easily.

Limitations

- Advanced customization may require Deluge scripting.
- Application design depends on the features available on the platform.

7. Result

Thus, a simple Student Management form was successfully designed and previewed in Zoho Creator. The experiment provided an understanding of how different field types and basic form settings can be used to collect and organize student information with reduced coding effort.